

Patient Discharge Instructions

HealthFirst General Hospital — Post-Discharge Care Guide

Important: Please read all instructions carefully before leaving the hospital. Contact your care team if you have any questions.

1. General Post-Discharge Instructions

- Rest for at least 24–48 hours after discharge. Avoid strenuous activity.
- Do not drive or operate heavy machinery if you were given sedatives or general anesthesia.
- Keep your follow-up appointment. Missing it may delay your recovery.
- Maintain adequate hydration — drink at least 8 glasses of water daily unless restricted.
- Follow dietary restrictions provided by your physician or dietitian.

2. Wound and Incision Care

Keep the wound area clean and dry for the first 48 hours. Change dressings as instructed by your nurse. Do not submerge the wound in water (no baths, swimming) until cleared by your physician. Shower with waterproof dressing or keep area dry. Watch for signs of infection.

- Increased redness, swelling, or warmth around the wound
- Pus or unusual discharge from the incision site
- Fever above 38.5 C (101.3 F)
- Wound edges separating or sutures breaking

3. Medication Instructions

Medication	Dose	Frequency	Duration	Notes
Amoxicillin 500mg	1 capsule	3x daily	7 days	Take with food
Ibuprofen 400mg	1 tablet	As needed	Up to 5 days	Max 3 doses/day
Omeprazole 20mg	1 capsule	Once daily	14 days	Take before meals

Note: This is a sample medication list for illustrative purposes only. Always follow the actual prescription label and consult your pharmacist for drug interactions.

4. Activity Restrictions

Activity	Restriction Period
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Driving	48 hours minimum or until off pain medication
Return to work (desk job)	3–5 days (consult physician)
Return to work (physical)	2–4 weeks (consult physician)
Exercise / gym	4 weeks minimum
Sexual activity	As advised by physician
Air travel	Discuss with physician if within 2 weeks

5. When to Call 911 / Go to Emergency Room

- Chest pain, pressure, or tightness
- Sudden difficulty breathing or shortness of breath
- Severe allergic reaction: hives, swelling of face/throat, difficulty swallowing
- Sudden confusion, slurred speech, or one-sided weakness (signs of stroke)
- Uncontrolled bleeding that does not stop with pressure
- Loss of consciousness or seizure

6. Follow-Up Appointment

Your follow-up appointment has been scheduled with your primary care physician within 7–10 days of discharge. You will receive a reminder call 24 hours before. To reschedule, contact our scheduling desk at 1-800-555-0199 at least 48 hours in advance. Failure to attend may result in referral back to emergency care if symptoms persist.